



Mobile curriculum

Institutes are moving away from the traditional desktop computer lab and integrating computers in the classroom as much as possible. This can be challenging when the institute has a limited budget, a short supply of free space or many students. Cabling is expensive—especially in older institutes which are constructed from bricks.

Wireless technology helps solve these issues. Our wireless technology allows laptops on mobile carts to access the Internet or campus network, without each connecting to a network cable or telephone line. Not only do these 'mobile classrooms' save space in a building, they also provide a better opportunity to integrate technology into the curriculum. By having the computers come into the classroom, the faculty members and students are more likely to utilise technology for all their instructional programmes.

Wireless Internet connectivity can be used in other ways too, such as turning a common area like the lunch room into an Internet café for students and faculty. It can also give administration the ability to roam the campus and still be connected to the network.

IP telephones in every classroom

IP telephony technology runs voice traffic over the same network as for data. It leverages the campus area network that most institutes already have in place, and eliminates the expense of having to buy and maintain expensive PBX gear and the support costs for moves, changes and additions. With IP phones, these changes can be done within minutes and at no charge.

Aside from cost savings, a huge advantage of IP telephony is how the IP phones can be used. Because they are on the same network as data, these phones can be used for attendance recording and tracking, locating students or teachers at any time during the school day, publicising school information like morning announcements and lunch menus, and getting emergency assistance. Voicemail for all teachers becomes a standard. And IP phones can be used as an institute's intercom system, which can amount to huge savings per year.

Other communications

Campus networks not only need to connect faculty, students, deans and administrators but parents as well. Building strong relationships between the home and the institute can be critical to students' success, and technology can enable this kind of communication.

With a portal on the Internet—a place where parents, faculty, teachers, students, deans, administrators and others can go to learn what's going on in the institute and feel part of the community—parents can communicate with teachers and administrators through e-mail, and securely access information about their children, such as attend-

ance and grades. Another use of the portal is as a recruitment tool. Because the portal is accessible 24 hours a day, authorised users can access the information during off hours.

Students can access their schedule, homework, and grades, and watch any class they missed—either live or at a later time. Teachers and administrators can use Web-enabled applications designed to help them become more productive. And administrators can broadcast live announcements via the portal, and then make them available for on-demand viewing at a later date.

Distance learning

"Education without walls" is a philosophy of 21st century schools. While much has been made of distance learning as a concept, many institutes are benefiting from it right now. Homebound children are staying in contact with their peers in the classroom—and staying engaged in education—through distance learning. Advanced students are getting the courses they need, without leaving their institute or peers. Whether the broadcast is live (for example, using tools like Webex) or accessed at a later time, the information is always there, letting students go back and review the material if needed. Video conferencing and telepresence with students in other countries are exposing students to new cultures and increasing their appreciation and knowledge of the world. There are thousands of hours of digital content that are currently available to supplement curriculum. With a strong network infrastructure, keeping in contact with distance learners is as easy as if they were physically present in the classroom.

This roadmap has provided you with just a glimpse of the possibilities when the right networking technology is implemented. The key to turning your vision into reality is to choose strategic partners that can support the vision while protecting your investments. ■



An IP phone